

Xavier Tierney

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EDUCATION

London School of Economics PhD in Economics, expected 2027	2021–present
London School of Economics MRes in Economics, with Distinction	2023
London School of Economics MSc in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics, with Distinction	2021
University of Oxford, Balliol College BA in Physics and Philosophy, First Class Honours	2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Urban **Secondary:** Development, Labour

JOB MARKET PAPER

Lopsided Cities: Employment-Residence Mismatches and Place-Based Responses

Many cities have lopsided employment distributions: the center of business is tied to one side of the city, while residences sprawl out in the other direction. This means average distances to employment are further than they would be in a symmetric city – increasing commute times. In this paper, I investigate the costs of such lopsidedness, its impact on inequality and possible policy responses. Calibrating a quantitative urban model to Sydney, I show that a counterfactual city with a more centralised employment hub could have several percentage points higher output and worker welfare, particularly for the low-skill workers currently far from the existing center. I then investigate the effects of a government policy to try to directly alter the spatial distribution of employment: a 2018 policy to shift over 10,000 government jobs to a more central location in Sydney. Using a synthetic control method, I find that land values surrounding the new offices increased substantially compared to comparable locations, while private employment responses were initially muted, except for some high-skill sectors. I then estimate a dynamic quantitative urban model, showing that the initial land value impacts are consistent with significant spillovers to the private sector, but that employment responses may be delayed by construction lags and sticky labour markets.

TEACHING

PP440 Micro and Macro Economics for Public Policy (graduate), LSE Teaching assistant for Luis Garicano and Ethan Ilzetzki	2024/25, 2025/26
EC1A5 Microeconomics I (undergraduate), LSE Teaching assistant for Alan Manning	2023/24
EC1B5 Macroeconomics I (undergraduate), LSE Teaching assistant for Rachel Ngai and Keyu Jin	2022/23, 2023/24
Awards: LSE Excellence in Education Award (2025); Economics Department teaching bonus award (2023, 2024)	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Professor Gharad Bryan, LSE	2024
Research Assistant to Professors Oriana Bandiera and Robin Burgess, LSE	2019–2020
Research Scholar, Future of Humanity Institute, University of Oxford Salaried research fellowship. Worked with the Centre for the Governance of AI on market concentration, the economics of protectionism and trends in technological progress	2018–2019
Research Assistant to Professor Armin Reichold, Particle Physics, University of Oxford	2018

HONOURS AND AWARDS

LSE Job Market Fund	2026–2027
LSE Excellence in Education Award	2025
LSE Economics Department teaching bonus award	2023, 2024
LSE PhD Scholarship	2021–2026
Theobald Scholarship, Balliol College	2017

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: *Economica*

Service: Co-organiser, Development Economics Research Breakfast, LSE

Mentoring: Applicant Mentor Programme for PhD applicants from underrepresented backgrounds

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Programming: R, MATLAB, Python, Stata, QGIS, $\LaTeX$

Citizenship and residency: Australia, the Netherlands (citizen); UK settled status

REFERENCES

Daniel Sturm

Professor of Economics
London School of Economics
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Gharad Bryan

Associate Professor of Economics
London School of Economics
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Henry Overman

Professor of Economic Geography
London School of Economics
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